

Nityam Thakur

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EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz

Santa Cruz, CA

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science: Game Design

Sep 2021 – Jun 2025

- Dean's Honor for Sophomore Year(Winter 2022)
- Key Modules: Advanced Computer Networks; Advanced Programming(Game AI); Creating Digital Audio; Game Systems; Rapid Prototyping; Applied Discrete Mathematics; UI/UX Design

WORK EXPERIENCE & PROJECTS

"2025" – Narrative Puzzle Game Integrated in Unity

Santa Cruz, CA

Tools Lead | Programmer | Story Writer

Jan 2025 – June 2025

- Collaborated with a team to design and release(on Steam) "2025", a narrative-driven, point-and-click puzzle game exploring media censorship and disinformation within a satirical, dystopian narrative
- Designed modular game systems using Unity's prefab architecture, enabling near-instant scene transitions and a consistent 60–120 FPS performance.
- Optimized demo install size to 47 MB through aggressive asset compression and custom load behavior.
- Developed accessibility features including grayscale mode, mouse-only controls, and one-handed play support.
- Managed GitHub version control and cross-team integrations to avoid merge conflicts and ensure collaborative efficiency.

Chess AI

Santa Cruz, CA

Dec 2024 – Ongoing

- Developed a chess AI in C++ using ImGui, with FEN parsing, and a depth-limited search-based AI.
- Learned game state management, algorithmic decision-making, and UI programming in a systems-level environment.
- Ongoing personal project I continue refining to improve my AI logic, explore advanced strategies, and raise performance on chess ELO test bots.

Campus Network Portfolio

Santa Cruz, CA

Network Engineer

Apr 2024 – Jun 2024

- Designed and configured a comprehensive campus network, including core, distribution, and access layers, using Cisco IOS command line.
- Implemented VLANs, inter-VLAN routing via SVIs, and HSRP (HSRP) for gateway redundancy.
- Enabled trunking, EtherChannel (LACP), STP/RSTP with BPDU Guard, and DHCP relay for efficient and secure traffic flow

One97 Communications Ltd(Paytm)

Noida, India

Data Science Intern

June 2023 – July 2023

- Developed an expenditure forecasting tool using Python and PySpark, enhancing financial predictions and budget management.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to align the tool with business objectives and presented findings to senior management.
- Processed and analyzed large datasets, applying machine learning algorithms for predictive modeling.
- Strengthened skills in Python, SQL, and big data tools through hands-on experience.

EXTRA-CURRICULARS

Trained in Music

Santa Cruz, CA

Drummer | Music Artist

July 2024 – Present

- Completed Grade 6 Rockschoool and Level 5 Musicology
- Now apply rhythm theory and musical knowledge to compose and produce original music using REAPER.

CRY Foundation

Noida, India

Fundraiserr | Tutor

Jan 2020 – August 2020

- Helped raise 8 lakh INR (10630 USD) to help children get access to online classes and rations during the COVID-19.
- Taught Mathematics and English to underprivileged middle school children for one school term.

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

Skills: Data Handling/Processing, Phaser, Figma, AWS, Microsoft Office Suite, Vision-based AI

Languages: English, Hindi, French(DELF A1 + second-year French during college)